

TAILSPIN CIVIC SYSTEMS, INC.

System Security Plan (SSP)

AwardWorks Grants Management Platform

FedRAMP Moderate Baseline | NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5 | NIST RMF (SP 800-37 Rev. 2)
Version 2.1 | Effective: 2026-03-01 | Prepared by: Chris Morrissey, ISSO
Sample GRC portfolio artifact — fictional company and system

1. System Identification

System Name	AwardWorks Grants Management Platform
System Abbreviation	AWARDWORKS
Cloud Service Provider	Tailspin Civic Systems, Inc.
Service Model	Software as a Service (SaaS)
Deployment Model	Public Cloud (multi-tenant, logically isolated per agency)
Authorization Path	FedRAMP Agency ATO (sponsoring agency: U.S. Department of Community Development — fictional)
Security Categorization	FIPS 199 Moderate (see Section 3)
Baseline Applied	FedRAMP Moderate — 323 controls and enhancements
Underlying IaaS	AWS GovCloud (US) — FedRAMP High P-ATO, inheritance documented in the Control Implementation Summary
Authorizing Official (AO)	Chief Information Officer, sponsoring agency
System Owner	VP of Product, Tailspin Civic Systems
ISSO	Chris Morrissey
3PAO	Independent Third-Party Assessment Organization (A2LA-accredited)

2. System Description and Purpose

AwardWorks is a multi-tenant Software-as-a-Service platform that enables federal, state, and local government agencies to administer the full grants lifecycle — opportunity publication, applicant intake, eligibility review, award issuance, subrecipient monitoring, financial drawdown, and closeout reporting.

The system processes application data submitted by grant applicants (including individuals and organizations), award and financial disbursement records, and subrecipient performance reporting. It does not process classified information. It does process Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) and personally identifiable information (PII) belonging to individual applicants, including names, contact information, taxpayer identification numbers, and financial account details for disbursement.

2.1 User Roles

Role	User Population	Access Description
Agency Program Officer	Federal/state agency staff	Reviews applications, issues awards, monitors subrecipient performance

Agency Administrator	Federal/state agency staff	Manages agency-level configuration, user provisioning, and reporting within their tenant
Applicant / Grantee	External public users	Submits applications, uploads supporting documents, files performance reports
CSP Support Engineer	Tailspin Civic Systems personnel	Break-fix support; access is time-bound, approved, and session-recorded
CSP System Administrator	Tailspin Civic Systems personnel	Privileged infrastructure access via bastion with phishing-resistant MFA

3. FIPS 199 Security Categorization

The security categorization was determined in accordance with FIPS Publication 199 and NIST SP 800-60 Volume II, based on the information types processed by the system.

Information Type (SP 800-60)	Confidentiality	Integrity	Availability
C.2.8.12 — Grants Management	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate
C.3.5.1 — Financial Disbursement / Payment	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate
C.2.8.9 — Personal Identity and Authentication	Moderate	Moderate	Low
C.3.4.1 — Reporting and Information Dissemination	Low	Moderate	Low

Applying the high water mark across all information types, the overall system security categorization is:

Overall Categorization	MODERATE (Confidentiality: Moderate, Integrity: Moderate, Availability: Moderate)
Rationale	Unauthorized disclosure of applicant PII and financial account data would cause serious adverse effect on individuals; loss of integrity in award or disbursement records could result in improper payments; extended unavailability would disrupt statutorily deadlines grant cycles.

4. Authorization Boundary

The authorization boundary encompasses all components of the AwardWorks platform that store, process, or transmit federal information, deployed within a dedicated AWS GovCloud (US) account managed exclusively by Tailspin Civic Systems.

4.1 Components Inside the Boundary

- Public-facing web application tier (containerized, behind AWS WAF and Application Load Balancer)
- Application API tier and asynchronous batch processing services
- Primary relational database (encrypted, multi-AZ, point-in-time recovery enabled)
- Document storage (S3 with customer-managed KMS encryption and object-level access logging)
- Identity provider integration layer supporting agency SSO (SAML/OIDC) and Login.gov for external applicants
- Logging, monitoring, and SIEM pipeline (CloudTrail, VPC Flow Logs, host and container telemetry)
- Bastion/jump host used for all privileged administrative access, with session recording

4.2 Components Outside the Boundary

- AWS GovCloud underlying infrastructure — physical, environmental, and hypervisor controls are inherited under the AWS FedRAMP High P-ATO
- Agency-side identity providers and agency endpoint devices — customer responsibility
- Tailspin Civic Systems corporate IT (email, HR systems) — no federal data traverses these systems; corporate controls are documented as Service Provider Corporate origination

4.3 External Services and Interconnections

External Service	Data Exchanged	Protection Mechanism
Login.gov	Applicant authentication assertions	SAML 2.0 over TLS 1.2+; no credentials stored by AwardWorks; FedRAMP-authorized service
U.S. Treasury Payment Interface	Disbursement instruction files	Mutual TLS with certificate pinning; files encrypted at rest prior to transmission; SFTP over dedicated connection
SAM.gov API	Entity registration and exclusion status validation	TLS 1.2+; read-only; API key stored in AWS Secrets Manager

5. Control Implementation Approach

Control implementations are documented in full in the accompanying Security Controls Traceability Matrix (SCTM). Each control is assigned an implementation status and a control origination, which establishes accountability across the shared responsibility model.

Control Origination	Definition
Service Provider Corporate	Control is implemented organization-wide by Tailspin Civic Systems and applies to all systems (e.g., personnel screening, security awareness training)
Service Provider System-Specific	Control is implemented uniquely for the AwardWorks system (e.g., boundary protection, audit event selection)
Inherited	Control is fully inherited from AWS GovCloud under its FedRAMP High P-ATO (e.g., physical access control, media sanitization)
Shared	Responsibility is divided between Tailspin Civic Systems and the customer agency (e.g., account management, where the CSP provides capability and the agency administers its own users)
Customer (Configured)	Control must be configured by the customer agency; described in the Customer Responsibility Matrix

As of the current assessment, 20 of 30 sampled controls are fully Implemented, 8 are Partially Implemented with corresponding POA&M items, and 2 are fully Inherited. Deficiencies are tracked to closure in the Plan of Action and Milestones.

6. Continuous Monitoring Strategy

Tailspin Civic Systems maintains an ongoing authorization posture through a documented continuous monitoring program aligned to the FedRAMP Continuous Monitoring Strategy Guide.

Activity	Frequency	Deliverable / Evidence
Authenticated vulnerability	Monthly	Raw scan results and remediation status submitted to

scanning (OS, web, database, container)		the AO
POA&M update and submission	Monthly	Updated POA&M with milestone progress and closures
System inventory reconciliation	Monthly	Updated integrated inventory workbook
Configuration drift detection	Continuous (automated)	AWS Config compliance reports and remediation records
Audit log review	Weekly	Ticketed review record with reviewer, findings, and escalations
Annual security assessment (3PAO)	Annually	Security Assessment Report (SAR) and updated SSP
Contingency plan test	Annually	After-action report with measured RTO/RPO
Incident response tabletop	Annually	Exercise report and updated IR Plan
Significant change request	As needed	Significant Change Request submitted to AO prior to implementation

7. Incident Response and Reporting

Security incidents are handled per the AwardWorks Incident Response Plan, which defines severity tiers, escalation paths, and a 24x7 on-call rotation. Consistent with FedRAMP requirements, confirmed or suspected incidents involving federal information are reported to US-CERT and to the sponsoring agency ISSO within one hour of determination. Incident records are retained and reviewed during the annual assessment.

8. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Authorizing Official (AO)	Accepts residual risk on behalf of the agency and issues the Authority to Operate
Information System Security Officer (ISSO)	Maintains the SSP and POA&M; coordinates continuous monitoring deliverables; serves as the primary security point of contact to the AO
System Owner	Accountable for overall system operation, budget, and security posture
Third-Party Assessment Organization (3PAO)	Performs independent security control assessment and produces the SAR
Security Operations	Executes monitoring, detection, and incident response activities
Platform Engineering	Implements and maintains technical controls; performs remediation

9. Related Documentation

- Security Controls Traceability Matrix (SCTM) — control-by-control implementation and assessment results
- Security Assessment Report (SAR) — independent assessment findings and risk determinations
- Plan of Action and Milestones (POA&M) — tracked remediation of identified weaknesses
- Contingency Plan, Incident Response Plan, and Configuration Management Plan — maintained separately and referenced by their respective control families

10. Document Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	2025-08-01	C. Morrissey, ISSO	Initial SSP issuance for FedRAMP Moderate authorization
2.0	2026-01-15	C. Morrissey, ISSO	Updated authorization boundary following Login.gov integration; added external interconnection detail
2.1	2026-03-01	C. Morrissey, ISSO	Incorporated 3PAO assessment results; updated control implementation statuses and linked POA&M identifiers